

Resume Critique Worksheet

Refer to the below tips and your resume critique for suggestions on optimizing and tailoring your resume.

Applicant Tracking System (ATS) Software Compatibility

- Your name and contact information should not be placed in a header on page 1.
- There should be no tables or text boxes.

Why is this so important? ATS is a software that companies use to read, classify, score, filter, and rank resumes. Text placed in a header, table, or text box cannot be read by ATS software, impacting your score.

Resume Format & Page Length

- Ensure consistent formatting throughout your entire resume, including font, headings, job titles, and bullet points.
- The industry standard for a resume is 1 to 2 pages, focusing on your most recent and relevant experience.

Remember, a resume's goal is to get you an interview where you can go into further detail regarding your career history and value you offer potential employers.

Resume Hot Zone

- Include a Target Job Title, Career Summary, and Key Skills section at the top of your resume.
- Do not include an objective statement, as it's an outdated practice and often overlooked by employers.

The top third of the first page of your resume is vital to making a great first impression. These sections help your resume stand out, grab a hiring managers attention, and provide an overview of your background and capabilities.

Content

- Focus on your achievements and what sets you apart from other candidates.
- Avoid using "responsible for" or "responsibilities include."
- Clarify company-specific jargon and acronyms.

On average, hiring managers spend 7-10 seconds reviewing a resume. Make sure your resume stands out by using strong action verbs and focusing on your accomplishments.

Tailoring & Proofreading

- Be sure to tailor your resume to match each position you are applying for.
- Review grammar, punctuation, and spelling for each tailored resume before sending it out.

Tailoring not only helps when applying online, it also showcases to hiring managers how you are a fit for the role. Potential employers want to see that you have the skills, qualifications, and experience they are looking for.

Connect with your coach and access additional articles, resources, and webinars in your Randstad RiseSmart online portal for further support with your resume and career transition.